

PROPOSAL & FUNCTIONAL SPECIFICATION

The School Website

A public website for Nairobi Green Valley Academy, joined to the school's management system

Prepared for	Nairobi Green Valley Academy — Board & Senior Management
Subject	Scope, functionality and delivery plan for greenvallley.ac.ke
Companion system	Green Valley School Management System (live)
Parent & student portal	school-mgmt-sage.vercel.app/portal
Date	22 September 2026
Status	For review and approval

1. Why the school needs this website

The school already runs a complete management system: admissions, classes, marks, report cards, fees through the ledger, transport, boarding and the library. What it does not yet have is a **front door** — a public place where a parent who has never met the school can find it, judge it, ask a question and start an application without picking up the phone.

Today every enquiry arrives as a phone call or a walk-in during office hours. Each one costs staff time, arrives without a record, and is lost the moment the call ends. A website turns that traffic into something the school owns:

What happens today	What the website changes
A parent phones to ask about fees, the bus route or when the term starts.	They read it on the site at 9 pm, and only call when they are ready to apply.
An enquiry is written on a notepad and followed up if someone remembers.	The enquiry lands in the system as a record with a name, a phone number and a status, and is followed up because it appears on a list.
An application form is collected from the gate, filled by hand, and re-typed by the registrar.	The parent applies online; the application appears in the Admissions pipeline ready for review — no re-typing, no lost forms.
Parents ask the office for a fee balance or a report card.	They sign in to the portal and see it themselves, any time.
Newsletters and notices are printed and sent home with the child.	They are published once and reach every parent by web, e-mail and SMS.
A prospective parent Googles the school and finds nothing, or a Facebook page from 2019.	The school is the first, authoritative result — and is the source that AI assistants quote when asked about it.

The single most important principle in this document

The website is **not a second system**. It is a public face on the system the school already runs. Term dates, fee structures, notices, transport routes and the admissions pipeline all live in the management system; the website reads from it and writes back into it. Anything that is typed twice will, sooner or later, disagree with itself.

Objectives, in the order they matter

1. **Convert enquiries into applications.** Every page should make the next step obvious: enquire, book a tour, or apply.
2. **Answer the repeated questions** — fees, term dates, uniform, transport, entry requirements — so the office answers fewer of them.
3. **Serve the parents the school already has:** notices, calendar, results, fee statements, payments.
4. **Present the school honestly and well** to families, to the Ministry, and to prospective staff.
5. **Be legible to machines** — search engines and AI assistants — because that is increasingly how parents find a school.

Who the website is for

Audience	What they came for	What we must give them
Prospective parent	Is this school right for my child, can I afford it, how do I apply?	Curriculum, results, fees, photos, an honest tour, a short application form.
Current parent	When does term end? Is the bus running? What is my balance?	Calendar, notices, and one obvious <i>Parent Portal</i> button.
Student	Timetable, results, clubs, library.	Portal sign-in and student life pages.
Prospective staff	Are there vacancies, and what is it like to work here?	Careers page with an application form.
Ministry, partners, suppliers	Registration details, leadership, contacts, tenders.	About, governance, procurement, contact.
Search engines & AI assistants	Facts about the school.	Structured, machine-readable data (section 9).

2. Contents

1. Why the school needs this website
2. Contents
3. Sitemap and page inventory
 - Public pages
 - URL conventions
4. Page-by-page functionality
 - Home
 - About & governance
 - Academics
 - Admissions
 - Fees & payments
 - Student life
 - School services — transport, boarding, library
 - News, notices & events
 - Gallery & media
 - Careers
 - Contact & enquiries
 - Downloads & policies
5. Portals — the parent, student and staff doors
6. Online admissions, end to end
7. Enquiries: the form that must never lose a lead
8. Integration with the management system
9. Making the site AI-friendly and findable
10. Accessibility, language and inclusion
11. Content: who writes what, and what we need from the school
12. Who can edit the site (roles and workflow)
13. Technical approach, hosting and cost
14. Security, privacy and child protection
15. Measuring whether it works
16. Delivery plan and phases
17. Launch checklist
18. Appendix A — Enquiry and application field lists
19. Appendix B — Structured data examples
20. Appendix C — Decisions needed from the school

3. Sitemap and page inventory

3.1 Public pages

Seven items in the main menu. Anything more and parents stop reading it. Everything else is reachable from a page or the footer.

Home

└ About Us

- └ Our Story & Mission
- └ Our Team (teaching & support)
- └ Campus & Facilities

- └ Leadership & Governance
- └ Accreditation & Registration
- └ Careers

└ Academics

- └ Pre-Primary (PP1-PP2)
- └ Lower Primary (Grade 1-3)
- └ Subjects & Electives
- └ Academic Calendar & Term Dates

- └ Upper Primary (Grade 4-6)
- └ Junior Secondary (Grade 7-9)
- └ Assessment & Reporting (CBC)
- └ Examination Results

★ the commercial heart of the site

└ Admissions

- └ Why Green Valley
- └ How to Apply (4 steps)
- └ Fees & Payment Options
- └ Scholarships & Bursaries

- └ Entry Requirements by Grade
- └ Apply Online → feeds the MIS pipeline
- └ Book a School Tour
- └ Admissions FAQ

└ Student Life

- └ Clubs & Societies
- └ Music, Drama & Arts
- └ Counselling & Wellbeing
- └ Library

- └ Sports & Games
- └ Boarding Life
- └ School Bus & Routes
- └ A Day at Green Valley

└ News & Events

- └ Latest News
- └ Notices to Parents
- └ Gallery (photos & video)

- └ Events Calendar
- └ Newsletters (archive)
- └ Achievements

└ Contact

- └ Find Us (map, directions)
- └ Departments & Direct Lines

- └ Make an Enquiry
- └ Visit Us

└ Portal → sign-in for parents, students and staff

Footer: Downloads · Policies (Privacy, Safeguarding, Anti-Bullying) · Term Dates ·
Fee Structure · Alumni · Procurement/Tenders · Sitemap · Social links

3.2 URL conventions

Short, lower-case, hyphenated, never changing. The URL is quoted in letters and posters for years; a URL that breaks is a lost parent.

URL	Page
/	Home
/admissions	Admissions overview
/admissions/apply	Online application form
/admissions/fees	Fee structure and payment options
/admissions/tour	Book a school tour
/academics/junior-secondary	One page per education level
/academics/calendar	Term dates, published from the MIS
/news/<year>/<slug>	A news article
/events/<slug>	An event with date, venue and RSVP
/transport	Routes, stops and times

URL	Page
/contact	Contact and enquiry form
/portal	Redirect to the parent/student portal sign-in
/downloads/<slug>.pdf	Fee structure, calendar, uniform list, policies

4. Page-by-page functionality

Priority key: **P1** launch **P2** soon after **P3** later **AI** machine-readable content.

4.1 Home **P1**

A visitor decides in about eight seconds whether to keep reading. The home page must answer *what kind of school is this, for which ages, where, and what do I do next* — above the fold, before any scrolling.

- **Hero** — one strong photograph of real children on the real campus, the school name and motto (“Knowledge, Character, Excellence”), and two buttons: *Apply Online* and *Book a Tour*.
- **Quick-answer strip** — Pre-Primary to Junior Secondary · Day & Boarding · CBC curriculum · Kiambu Road, Nairobi. Four facts, no prose.
- **Why families choose us** — four to six cards, each a claim with evidence (class size, teacher qualifications, results, facilities).
- **Levels at a glance** — four tiles linking to the level pages, each with the age range and a one-line promise.
- **Latest news & notices** **AI** — three most recent items, pulled live from the MIS announcements so nobody has to copy them.
- **Upcoming dates** — next three calendar events, from the MIS academic calendar.
- **Parent Portal** — a prominent panel: check fees, results, attendance. Signed-in parents should never have to hunt for it.
- **Proof** — parent and alumni testimonials with names and photos (with consent), plus accreditation marks.
- **Closing call to action** — enquiry form inline (name, phone, child’s grade) so nobody has to navigate to contact us.
- **Footer** — address, map, phone, e-mail, office hours, paybill, social links, policy links.

4.2 About & governance **P1**

- **Our story and mission** — founding, philosophy, values, what the school is deliberately *not*.
- **Leadership** — Principal’s welcome (photo, signature, 200 words), Deputy/Registrar, Board of Directors or Trustees, PTA chair.
- **Our team** — teaching staff with photo, subject and qualification; support staff by department. *Can be generated from HR records; individual consent required before a photo is published.*
- **Accreditation & registration** **AI** — Ministry registration [MOE/PS/2016/1187](#), licence [PRI/2016/00417](#), KNEC centre number, associations. Parents and the Ministry both look for these.
- **Campus & facilities** — classrooms, science and computer labs, library, dining hall, dormitories, playing fields, sick bay, bus fleet; photographs and a short walkthrough video.
- **Safeguarding statement** — child protection policy, staff vetting, visitor rules, CCTV, gate procedure. Increasingly the first thing a careful parent reads.

4.3 Academics **P1**

- **One page per level** (Pre-Primary, Lower Primary, Upper Primary, Junior Secondary): ages, typical day, learning areas, class sizes, assessment, transition to the next level, the teachers, the fees for that level, and a call to apply.
- **Subjects & electives** — the learning areas offered, which are core and which are chosen, drawn from the subject list in the MIS so the website cannot drift from what is actually taught.
- **Assessment & reporting (CBC)** — how continuous assessment, exams and competency bands work; what a report card looks like (sample, anonymised); when results are published; how parents access them (*link to*

the portal).

- **Academic calendar** **AI** — term dates, half-terms, exam weeks, closing and opening days, published straight from the MIS. One source, one truth. Downloadable as PDF and subscribable as a calendar feed (.ics) so it lands in a parent's phone.
- **Results & achievements** — school-level performance, national exam outcomes, competition results. Never individual pupils' marks.
- **Homework & reading policy**, book lists per grade (PDF).

4.4 Admissions **P1** — the commercial heart of the site

Treat this as the school's shop window. Everything else exists to bring a parent here.

- **How to apply** — four numbered steps with realistic timelines: 1. *Enquire or tour* → 2. *Apply online* → 3. *Assessment & interview* → 4. *Offer, acceptance and reporting day*.
- **Entry requirements per grade** — age on 1 January, documents required (birth certificate, previous report, transfer letter, immunisation card, NEMIS/assessment number, passport photos), what a transfer needs.
- **Apply online** — the form itself (section 6 and Appendix A). Saves progress, accepts document uploads, works on a phone.
- **Intakes & deadlines** — when the school takes new pupils, when places typically fill, waiting-list policy.
- **Fees for applicants** — full fee structure, what is included, what is extra, payment plans, the application fee and whether it is refundable.
- **Scholarships & bursaries** — what exists, who qualifies, how to apply, deadline, and how decisions are communicated.
- **Book a tour** — a date/time picker showing the school's open slots; confirmation by e-mail and SMS; a reminder the day before; the visit recorded in the MIS.
- **Admissions FAQ** **AI** — twenty real questions with direct answers. This page will attract more search traffic than any other and is what AI assistants will quote.
- **Talk to the registrar** — name, photo, direct line, WhatsApp, and office hours. Admissions is a human decision; parents want a person.

4.5 Fees & payments **P1**

- **Published fee structure** per level and per term: tuition, boarding, lunch, transport, activity, examination and one-off charges, with a clear note on what is compulsory and what is optional. Generated from the MIS fee structure, so the published figure is the figure that will be invoiced.
- **Payment options** — M-Pesa paybill 522533 with the child's admission number as the account, bank transfer details, banker's cheque, and the instalment plan.
- **Fee calculator** **P2** — pick a grade, boarder or day, bus route and options; see the termly and annual total. Removes the most common phone call the bursar receives.
- **Discounts** — sibling discount, early-payment discount, bursaries: stated plainly with the conditions.
- **Pay now** — a button that takes a signed-in parent to the portal, where an M-Pesa STK push can be sent to their own phone for their own child.
- **Fee policy** — due dates, what happens when fees are late, refunds on withdrawal, and who to talk to about difficulty paying.

4.6 Student life P2

- **A day at Green Valley** — an hour-by-hour walkthrough for a day scholar and for a boarder. Parents picture their own child in it.
- **Clubs & societies, sports, music, drama and arts** — what is offered per term, who runs it, photographs, and results.
- **Boarding life** — the houses, dormitories and beds, the warden, the weekly routine, prep times, visiting days, exeat rules, what to pack (downloadable list), meals and the menu cycle.
- **Counselling & wellbeing** — the counsellor, the sick bay and nurse, medical procedures, how a parent is contacted in an emergency, the anti-bullying policy.
- **Student leadership** — the council, prefects, service and community projects.

4.7 School services — transport, boarding, library P2

These three pages exist because the management system already holds the data; publishing them costs almost nothing and answers a great many phone calls.

- **Transport** AI — every route with its stops, pick-up and drop-off times, the termly fare, the buses and their capacity, and the rules (a child is released only to a named adult, a change of stop needs a written request). Fed live from the transport module, so a route change is published the moment the transport office makes it.
- **Boarding** — the houses, what a dormitory looks like, the kit list, laundry, prep and lights-out, visiting days.
- **Library** — opening hours, borrowing rules (how many books, for how long, what a late return costs), the reading programme, and P3 a public catalogue search so a pupil can check whether a title is on the shelf before walking over.

4.8 News, notices & events P1 AI

- **News** — articles with a photograph, author, date and category; tags per level so a Grade 3 parent can filter to what concerns them.
- **Notices to parents** — published from the MIS announcements. Write once in the system; it reaches the website, e-mail and SMS together.
- **Events calendar** — month and list views, each event with date, time, venue, audience, and where relevant an RSVP; downloadable `.ics` and subscribable.
- **Newsletters** — a browsable archive of termly newsletters as PDFs.
- **Achievements** — academic, sporting and arts results as they happen. This is the content that makes a school look alive.
- **Emergency banner** — a red strip across every page for a closure, a change of reporting date or a security notice, switched on from the MIS in one click. Rarely used, indispensable when needed.

4.9 Gallery & media P2

- Albums by event and term; images compressed and served responsively so they open quickly on a phone with a weak signal.
- Video: campus tour, sports day, music festival, the Principal's welcome.
- **Consent register** — no child's photograph is published without a recorded parental consent, and the consent flag lives on the pupil's record in the MIS. A parent can withdraw consent at any time and the image comes down.
- A virtual 360° tour P3 — valuable for families abroad or upcountry.

4.10 Careers **P2**

- Current vacancies with role, subject, level, contract type, closing date and the full description.
- An online application form with CV and certificate upload, feeding the HR recruitment list rather than an inbox.
- Why work here: professional development, benefits, staff testimonials.
- A speculative-application form for when there are no vacancies, and TSC/child-protection requirements stated up front.

4.11 Contact & enquiries **P1**

- Address, an embedded map with driving directions and a landmark, office hours, and the main lines.
- **Direct lines by department** — Admissions, Bursar, Transport, Boarding, Head Teacher — so a caller reaches the right desk first time.
- **Enquiry form** (section 7) — the most important form on the site after the application.
- WhatsApp business link, because that is how most Kenyan parents prefer to ask a quick question.
- A map of where the school buses run, for families deciding whether the location works.

4.12 Downloads & policies **P1**

One page, everything a parent is ever asked to “collect from the office”: fee structure, term dates, uniform and kit lists, book lists, boarding packing list, medical form, consent forms, transport request, transfer request, privacy policy, safeguarding policy, anti-bullying policy, code of conduct, parent handbook.

5. Portals — the parent, student and staff doors

The website is public; the portal is personal. The site's job is to get the right person to the right door in one click, and never to duplicate what is behind it.

Door	Link	Who, and what they see
Parent & Student Portal	school-mgmt-sage.vercel.app/portal	Timetable · marks and published report cards · attendance · fee statement and <i>Pay with M-Pesa</i> · announcements · bus route, stop and times · boarding house and bed · library books out and any fines. A parent with several children switches between them.
Sign in	school-mgmt-sage.vercel.app/login	The single sign-in for every role. Where the <i>Portal</i> button in the header leads.
Staff Self Service	school-mgmt-sage.vercel.app/dashboard	Payslips, P9, leave, imprests and requisitions; teachers additionally get My Classes — today's lessons, registers and marks entry; drivers get their bus and work tickets.
Apply online	/admissions/apply	Public, no account needed. Writes into the school's admissions pipeline.
Check my application	/admissions/status P2	Application number + phone number returns the current stage — no login, no phone call to the registrar.

Where the portal button belongs

Top-right of the header on every page, visually distinct from the menu, labelled **Parent Portal** (not "Login", which reads as staff-only); repeated in the footer and as a panel on the home page. When the eventual domain is in place it should also answer at `portal.greenvalley.ac.ke`, which is short enough to say over the phone.

6. Online admissions, end to end

This is the single highest-value function on the website. The flow below is designed so that a parent on a phone, with a patchy connection, can finish it in one sitting — and so the registrar never re-types anything.

The parent's journey

1. **Start** — grade applying for, intake term and year, how they heard about the school.
2. **The child** — names, date of birth (with an immediate check against the grade's age requirement), gender, nationality, current school, last grade completed, day or boarding, any medical or learning needs.
3. **Parents / guardians** — primary guardian's name, relationship, phone, e-mail, ID number, occupation, address; a second guardian optional; the phone number is verified with an SMS code, which alone removes most junk applications.
4. **Documents** — birth certificate, most recent report card, transfer letter, immunisation card, passport photograph. Uploaded as photos from the phone; the form says plainly which are required now and which may follow.

5. **Options** — transport (with the route and stop chosen from the live route list), boarding, lunch, electives where relevant.
6. **Declaration & consent** — truth of information, acceptance of the data-protection notice, consent (or refusal) for photography.
7. **Application fee** **P2** — optional M-Pesa STK push at submission; the receipt is attached to the application.
8. **Submit** — the parent receives an application number on screen, by SMS and by e-mail, with what happens next and when to expect it.

What happens on the school's side

- The application appears in **Admissions** in the management system as *New*, with its documents attached — no re-keying.
- The registrar moves it through the pipeline: *New* → *Under review* → *Assessment/Interview booked* → *Offered* → *Accepted* → *Admitted* (or *Waiting list* / *Declined*).
- Each move can notify the parent by SMS and e-mail automatically, with the message text kept in the system rather than in someone's head.
- On **Admit**, the system creates the pupil, issues the admission number, opens the fee account, places the child in a class, and — where chosen — assigns the bus route and the hostel bed. The website form and the school roll are the same record from beginning to end.

Design rules that decide whether the form is finished or abandoned

- Four short steps with a visible progress bar, never one long page.
- Everything saves as it is typed; a resume link is sent by SMS so an interrupted parent can return.
- Ask only what is needed to decide. Everything else can be collected at reporting.
- Phone-number and date fields formatted for Kenya; the whole form usable one-handed on a mid-range Android.
- Uploads accept photographs of documents, not just scans, and compress them client-side.
- Plain-language errors next to the field, never a single failure message at the top.
- A printable version for the rare parent who still prefers paper — the same fields, so the registrar can type it in once.

7. Enquiries: the form that must never lose a lead

Most visitors are not ready to apply. The enquiry form captures them anyway, and its only job is to be short.

- **Five fields:** parent's name, phone, e-mail (optional), child's grade of interest, and the question. Anything more reduces completion.
- It appears on the home page, the admissions page, every level page and the contact page — the same form, remembering which page it came from.
- On submit: an immediate thank-you with the expected response time, an SMS confirmation to the parent, an instant notification to the admissions desk, and a record created in the system with a status of *New*.
- Enquiries are worked as a list — *New* → *Contacted* → *Tour booked* → *Applied* → *Enrolled* → *Lost* — so the school can see, at the end of a term, how many enquiries the website produced and how many became pupils.
- Spam is kept out with an invisible check rather than a puzzle a parent has to solve.

- An enquiry that goes untouched for 48 hours should raise a flag. A lead left for a week is a lead lost to another school.

8. Integration with the management system

Everything below already exists in the school's system. The website reads it through a small, read-only public interface, and writes back only through the two public forms.

Website element	Source in the MIS	Direction	Effect
Notices & news feed	Announcements	read	Published once, appears on the site, by e-mail and by SMS.
Term dates & calendar	Academic years and terms	read	Dates can never contradict the school's own calendar.
Fee structure & calculator	Fee items and structures	read	The published fee is the fee that will be invoiced.
Subjects and electives	Subject setup	read	Curriculum pages stay true to what is taught.
Transport routes page	Transport routes and stops	read	A route change is public immediately.
Library catalogue search P3	Library titles and copies	read	Availability shown without exposing borrowers.
Staff directory	Employees (consented only)	read	New teacher appears once HR records them.
Online application	Admission applications	write	Lands in the pipeline; on admission becomes a pupil, a fee account and a class place.
Enquiry & tour booking	Enquiry list / calendar	write	Followed up on a list, measured at term end.
Careers application P2	HR recruitment	write	Applicants ranked in one place, not an inbox.
Portal links	Portal	link	No duplicate login on the website.

Rules for the join

- The public interface is **read-only** except for applications, enquiries and job applications, each of which is rate-limited and validated.
- It exposes **no personal data** — no pupil names, no marks, no balances. Those live behind the portal sign-in.
- Website pages are cached for a few minutes; notices and the emergency banner refresh immediately on publish.
- If the management system is briefly unreachable the website still serves its last good copy. A parent must never see an error because an internal system is restarting.

9. Making the site AI-friendly and findable

Parents increasingly ask an AI assistant before they ask Google, and assistants answer from sites they can parse. A site built as below is quoted accurately; a site of images and PDFs is skipped or, worse, guessed

about.

9.1 Structured data

- **School** on the home page: legal name, registration numbers, address with coordinates, phone, e-mail, curriculum, ages served, opening hours (Appendix B).
- **FAQPage** on the admissions and fees FAQs — the format assistants quote most readily.
- **Event** on every calendar entry; **NewsArticle** on every article; **JobPosting** on every vacancy; **BreadcrumbList** site-wide.
- A `sitemap.xml` that updates itself, and an `llms.txt` at the root summarising the school and pointing to the pages an assistant should read first.

9.2 Writing for both readers

- Every fact a parent might ask for exists as **text**, not only inside an image or a PDF. A fee structure that exists only as a scan is invisible to search and to assistants.
- One clear question per heading — “How much are fees for Grade 7?” outperforms “Financial Information”.
- Dates written in full (“Term 2 begins on Monday 4 May 2026”), never “next term”.
- Each page states plainly who it is for and what to do next.
- Descriptive alt text on every image; real captions, not file names.

9.3 A school assistant on the website P2

A chat box, bottom-right, that answers from the school’s own published content — fees, term dates, entry requirements, routes, uniform — and nothing else. It must:

- Answer only from the website and the public MIS data, and say “I don’t know, let me connect you to the office” rather than invent;
- Offer to capture an enquiry when it cannot answer, so the conversation still becomes a lead;
- Never discuss an individual pupil — that belongs behind the portal sign-in;
- Hand over to WhatsApp or a phone number during office hours;
- Keep a transcript the admissions office can read, which is also the best possible list of what the website should explain better.

9.4 Search visibility

- Target the phrases parents actually type: “private school Kiambu Road”, “CBC junior secondary Nairobi boarding”, “school fees Grade 7 Nairobi”.
- A Google Business Profile with photographs, hours and reviews, consistent with the site to the letter.
- Fast on a phone: under three seconds on 3G, images compressed, nothing that blocks the first paint.
- Correct titles and descriptions per page, and social preview cards so a shared link looks like the school and not a bare URL.

10. Accessibility, language and inclusion

- **WCAG 2.2 AA** as the standard: contrast, keyboard navigation, focus that is visible, labelled forms, captioned video, headings in order.
- **Phone first.** Most parents will only ever see the site on a phone; design for that screen and let the desktop follow.

- **Low bandwidth.** Pages must be usable on a slow connection — compressed images, no autoplaying video, no heavy fonts.
- **Language.** English throughout, with Kiswahili for the pages that matter most to every parent — admissions, fees, term dates, contact. **P2**
- **Print.** Fee structure, calendar and application pages must print cleanly on A4 — many parents still keep a folder.
- **Plain language.** Short sentences, no internal jargon, no acronym without its expansion.

11. Content: who writes what

Websites are delayed by missing content far more often than by missing code. This list should be assigned to named people with dates before development begins.

Item	Who provides it	Notes
Principal's welcome (200 words) + photo	Principal	Signed, warm, specific to this school.
Mission, vision, values, history	Board / Principal	Half a page each.
Leadership and board profiles	Principal's office	Photo, role, one-paragraph biography.
Staff list with qualifications	HR	From employee records; consent for photographs.
Level pages (4)	Deputy / Heads of level	A day in the level, learning areas, class size.
Fee structure per level	Bursar	Published from the system; approve the wording.
Term dates for the year	Registrar	Already in the system; confirm and publish.
Entry requirements and document list	Registrar	Per grade.
Twenty admissions FAQs	Registrar + Bursar	Take them from the questions actually asked at the counter.
Photography (campus, classrooms, sport, boarding, labs, buses)	Professional shoot	Half a day; the single biggest lift in perceived quality.
Campus video / virtual tour	Videographer P2	Two to three minutes.
Testimonials (4–6)	PTA / alumni	Name, photo, written consent.
Policies: privacy, safeguarding, anti-bullying, code of conduct	Board	Legal review before publication.
Uniform, book and boarding kit lists	Deputy / Matron	As text on the page, plus a PDF.
Transport routes and fares	Transport office	Already in the system; confirm.
Results and achievements	Academics office	School-level only, never individual pupils.

12. Who can edit the site

Role	Can change	Cannot change
Principal / Administrator	Everything, including publishing policies and the emergency banner	—
Communications officer	News, events, gallery, newsletters	Fees, policies, admissions rules
Registrar	Admissions pages, FAQs, entry requirements, calendar	Fees, staff records
Bursar	Fee pages and payment instructions	Academic content

Role	Can change	Cannot change
HR	Careers and staff directory	Everything else

- Editors work on a **draft** and *request publication*; a second person publishes. Two pairs of eyes on anything a parent will read.
- Every change is recorded — who, what, when — and any page can be rolled back.
- Fee and policy pages require the Principal's approval before they go live.

13. Technical approach, hosting and cost

- **Same technology as the management system** (Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL) so one team maintains both and the join between them is direct rather than bolted on.
- **Content management** — school staff edit through a simple admin screen, not by editing code. Pages, news, events, gallery and downloads are all editable; layout and structure are not.
- **Hosting** — the same platform as the MIS, with a global CDN, automatic HTTPS and daily backups. No server for the school to look after.
- **Domain** — `greenvalley.ac.ke` for the website and `portal.greenvalley.ac.ke` for the portal, with e-mail on the school's own domain.
- **Performance budget** — first meaningful paint under 2.5 s on 3G; every image compressed and sized; the site works with JavaScript disabled for the pages that only present information.
- **Environments** — a staging site the school reviews before anything reaches the public one.

Recurring cost	Indicative	Note
Domain (.ac.ke)	~KSh 2,000 / year	Registered in the school's name, not a vendor's.
Hosting & CDN	Free tier → ~KSh 3,000 / month	Shared with the MIS; the free tier carries a school this size comfortably.
Transactional e-mail	Free tier → ~KSh 2,500 / month	Confirmations and notices.
SMS	~KSh 0.80 / message	Already in use by the MIS.
Photography / video	One-off	The highest-return line in this table.
Maintenance & content support	Retainer or in-house	A site nobody updates ages faster than no site at all.

14. Security, privacy and child protection

- **Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019** — a plain-English privacy notice, a lawful basis for every form, a named data-protection contact, and a retention rule for unsuccessful applications (suggested: 12 months, then deletion).
- **Children's data is treated as sensitive.** No pupil name, photograph, mark or balance is ever public; all of it sits behind the portal sign-in.
- **Photographic consent** is recorded per child and is respected by the gallery automatically; withdrawal takes effect immediately.

- **Forms** are rate-limited, validated on the server, protected from spam, and their uploads are scanned and type-restricted.
- **Transport** — HTTPS everywhere, HSTS, secure headers, no third-party script that has not been reviewed.
- **Payments** — the school never handles card data; M-Pesa is initiated from the portal and confirmed by Safaricom's callback.
- **Safeguarding** — no staff or pupil personal phone numbers published; a clear route for reporting a concern; the safeguarding policy public.
- **Backups and recovery** — daily, tested, with a stated recovery time; and an annual review of who still has editing access.

15. Measuring whether it works

Measure	Target in year one	Why it matters
Online applications per intake	60% of all applications	The clearest return on the investment.
Enquiries per month	20+	The top of the admissions funnel.
Enquiry → application conversion	30%	Tests the admissions pages and the follow-up.
Application form completion rate	70%+	Below this, the form is too long.
Portal sign-ins per parent per term	3+	Fewer calls to the office.
Calls answered by the website	Down 30%	Ask the office; they will know before the analytics do.
Mobile share of visits	Expect 75–85%	Confirms where to spend design effort.
Search position for "private school Kiambu Road"	First page	Visibility to families nearby.

Privacy-respecting analytics (no advertising trackers), reviewed with the admissions office once a term — not left to accumulate unread.

16. Delivery plan

Phase	Duration	Delivers	Dependencies
0 — Discovery	1 week	Content inventory, photography brief, sitemap and wireframes signed off, domain secured.	Decisions in Appendix C.
1 — Foundation	2 weeks	Design system in the school's colours, page framework, CMS, hosting, staging site.	Logo and brand assets.
2 — Core pages	2 weeks	Home, About, four level pages, Contact, Downloads, portal links, enquiry form.	Written content, photographs.
3 — Admissions	2 weeks	Admissions pages, the online application, tour booking, FAQs, MIS pipeline integration.	Entry requirements, fee structure.
4 — Live content	1 week	News, notices, calendar, transport and fee data fed from the MIS; emergency banner.	Public read interface.
5 — Polish & launch	1 week	Accessibility audit, performance tuning, structured data, staff training, launch.	Sign-off.
6 — After launch	Ongoing	Careers, gallery, Kiswahili pages, fee calculator, website assistant, library catalogue, virtual tour.	Measured demand.

Eight to nine weeks to a public launch, assuming content and photographs arrive on time. Content is almost always the constraint, so phase 0 starts with names against every item in section 11.

17. Launch checklist

Content

- Every page proofread by two people
- Fees, term dates and requirements verified against the system
- No placeholder text or stock photo left
- Consent recorded for every face published
- Policies legally reviewed

Function

- Application submitted end-to-end on a real phone
- Enquiry reaches the office and the parent gets the SMS
- Portal links land on the right sign-in
- Every form tested with wrong input
- Emergency banner switched on and off

Technical

- HTTPS, redirects, 404 page
- Sitemap and llms.txt live; search console verified
- Backups running and restore tested
- Under 3 s on 3G; accessibility audit passed
- Analytics recording

People

- Editors trained; a one-page guide printed
- Admissions desk knows where enquiries land
- Someone named as responsible for the site
- Domain and hosting in the school's own accounts
- Launch announced by SMS, WhatsApp and assembly

Appendix A — Field lists

Enquiry form (5 fields — resist adding a sixth)

Parent’s name * · Phone * · E-mail · Grade of interest * · Message. Hidden: source page, date, UTM parameters.

Online application

Step	Fields (* required)
1. Application	Grade applying for * · Intake term and year * · Day or boarding * · How did you hear about us?
2. The child	First, middle and last name * · Date of birth * · Gender * · Nationality * · Birth-certificate number · Religion · Current school · Last grade completed · Reason for transfer · Medical conditions, allergies, medication · Special educational needs
3. Parents / guardians	Primary: full name * · relationship * · phone (SMS-verified) * · e-mail · national ID * · occupation · employer · postal and physical address * Secondary (optional): name · relationship · phone · e-mail Emergency contact: name * · relationship * · phone *
4. Options & documents	Transport: route and stop · Boarding preference · Lunch · Electives (where applicable) Uploads: birth certificate * · latest report card * · transfer letter · immunisation card · passport photograph *
Declaration	Information is true * · Data-protection notice accepted * · Photography consent (yes / no) * · Signature (typed name) * · Date *

Tour booking

Parent’s name * · Phone * · E-mail · Number of visitors * · Preferred date and slot (from available times) * · Grade of interest * · Anything you would like to see.

Appendix B — Structured data example

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "School",
  "name": "Nairobi Green Valley Academy",
  "alternateName": "Green Valley Academy",
  "slogan": "Knowledge, Character, Excellence",
  "url": "https://greenvalley.ac.ke",
  "logo": "https://greenvalley.ac.ke/logo.png",
  "telephone": "+254 700 100 200",
  "email": "info@greenvalley.ac.ke",
  "address": {
    "@type": "PostalAddress",
    "streetAddress": "Green Valley Road, off Kiambu Road",
    "postalCode": "00100",
    "addressLocality": "Nairobi",
    "addressRegion": "Nairobi County",
    "addressCountry": "KE"
  },
  "identifier": [
    { "@type": "PropertyValue", "name": "MoE Registration", "value": "MOE/PS/2016/1187" },
    { "@type": "PropertyValue", "name": "Licence", "value": "PRI/2016/00417" }
  ],
  "educationalCredentialAwarded": "Kenya Competency Based Curriculum (CBC)",
  "numberOfStudents": 128,
  "foundingDate": "2016",
  "openingHours": "Mo-Fr 07:00-17:00",
  "sameAs": ["https://facebook.com/...", "https://instagram.com/..."]
}
</script>
```

Comparable blocks: `FAQPage` on the FAQs, `Event` on calendar entries, `NewsArticle` on articles, `JobPosting` on vacancies.

Appendix C — Decisions needed from the school

1. **Domain** — confirm `greenvalley.ac.ke` is registered in the school's name, and agree the portal address.
2. **Fee publication** — publish the full fee structure openly, or show it only after an enquiry?
(Recommendation: publish. Parents distrust a school that hides its fees, and the office fields fewer calls.)
3. **Application fee** — charged at submission, or on acceptance of an offer?
4. **Photography consent** — the wording, and whether existing pupils need to be re-consented before launch.
5. **Who owns the website** — name the person responsible for content, and the person who approves publication.
6. **Kiswahili pages** — required at launch, or phase 6?
7. **Website assistant** — approve in principle, and agree what it must never discuss.
8. **Staff directory** — publish photographs and qualifications, or names and roles only?
9. **Tour slots** — which days and times the school will commit to.
10. **Response-time promise** — what the site tells a parent to expect after an enquiry. (One working day is credible and achievable.)

Nairobi Green Valley Academy · Green Valley Road, off Kiambu Road · P.O. Box 30871–00100, Nairobi · +254 700 100 200 ·
info@greenvalley.ac.ke

Website functional proposal, 22 September 2026 — prepared for review by the Board and Senior Management. Parent & student
portal: school-mgmt-sage.vercel.app/portal